

marketing campaigns, conferences and promotional activities.

THINK OUT OF THE BOX: HIGHLY PAID AND OFF-BEAT CAREER OPTIONS

The interesting thing about today's world is that it offers you opportunities to follow your passion and take the path less travelled. Many students choose off-beat careers like theatre, comedy, film-making, social media management, digital marketing and film production instead of pursuing traditional courses in engineering and medical fields. Career counselors find that students opting for careers related to their hobbies are on an increase in today's day and age. If you want to take up a career you are truly passionate about – try to gain subject-specific knowledge about the field of your interest. You may also join workshops and short-term courses to give you a flair for your chosen field of study. Getting practical experience in the field would add value as well as boost your resume. However, one must be cautious and fully convinced of their interests when they make off-beat careers their choice. It is for this reason that many prefer to take slow steps and have a safety net to fall back on family businesses or a well-paying corporate job while pursuing their interest in such courses online.

Chartered Accountant is also a highly paid job for which one needs to clear the exams directly conducted by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI).

Company Secretaryship is also a related area and extremely successful career option for students who take the commerce stream in their graduation. Institute of Company Secretary of India is the government body that conducts the exam for aspiring CS students. India has grown rapidly in various sectors, including start-ups which will further boost the job opportunities for CS.

The dominance of the internet and technology and the unprecedented surge in consumption of video media has led to some of the most rewarding careers in today's world. A career in animation is one of the most popular ones with students with imagination, designing abilities and the desire to create magic. Choosing a career in animation means you will create visual effects for films, commercials, video games, online education programs, gadgets and other forms of media using illustrations and software programs. The industry has an unlimited scope and well-trained professionals in the field are in high demand in India as well as abroad. Just like animation, the gaming industry has swept the market with many students entering the field as game designers or game developers. The profile requires designing characters, themes, rules, levels and such details of the game that will be available to clients to download on mobiles or other apps.



A student's holistic growth is the focal point of all student development programs at Sathyabama. Skill based learning, Research intuitive framework are embedded in our teaching pedagogy. Our placement cell works closely with all the departments to mould students for recruitment drives and to meet various companies entry requirements.

— Dr. Mariazeena Johnson, Chancellor , Sathyabama Institute of Science & Technology

Data Science is one of the top choices among career options in India. The recent pandemic has created ample opportunities for growth in this field. To be simply put, the study of data science requires a combination of programming, mathematics and statistics. Data science professionals are responsible for compiling data from reliable sources, cleansing them and organizing the data to analyse specific requirements of the given organization. The career has seen a leap in demand with a 40% increase since 2019. The educational qualification required is a BE/ BTech with no necessary coding experience. However, an understanding of consumer psychology, complex formulas and business acumen are desirable in candidates who apply for such careers.

Artificial Intelligence is another career choice that fascinates students from the science stream with an acumen for the planning process, deductions, object manipulations capabilities and knowledge representation. Almost 16,500 positions related to Artificial Intelligence were open in India as of July 2020 as per Analytics India Magazine. Corporate giants like Microsoft, IBM, Amazon, Accenture and others widely implement AI on a massive scale.

Coding is a core skill and essential in today's world. With technology that has seeped into our everyday lives; the application of coding becomes essential to all businesses. Learning the skill ensures a career bloom for average performers.

Another sought-after field of study in recent years is **Digital Marketing**. These professionals ensure that the products or services of the business are well marketed and work on brand building for the organization that further helps them generate revenues. Since the pandemic has driven most businesses online, the need for digital marketing has shown a marked increase.

We acknowledge that making career choices is a difficult decision. However, it is not so when one is well-informed and considers all factors before making the choice - knowledge of their potential and interests, good institutions and success ratio, placements and fundings, and career growth and financial stability. One litmus test can be what Barbara Sher says in her book *I Could Do Anything If I Only Knew What It Was: How to Discover What You Really Want and How to Get It:* "Every time you have to make a choice about anything, think "Does this go toward or away from what I want?" Always choose what goes toward what you want.

